

exhibition

Toons Galore

BANGALORE Where can George Bush, Albert Einstein, H.D. Deve Gowda and General Pervez Musharraf be found, all in one room? In Bangalore's first-of-its-kind cartoon gallery, of course. The 2,000 sq ft Indian Cartoon Gallery, operating at Midford House, the Nandi Infrastructure Corridor Enterprise (NICE) office building, inaugurated its three-month-long exhibition of key political cartoons on August 16.

The gallery, the initiative of a Bangalore-based body Indian Institute of Cartoon (IIC), is one of India's exclusive spaces for cartoonists and their workpieces. It is open to all amateurs and professional cartoonists and provides a fully operational 75-seater seminar hall for workshops, lectures, and brainstorming.

NICE Managing Director and IIC Chairman Ashok Kheny, the key supporter of the gallery, says he had always been an admirer of cartoons and felt that he should take the initiative to provide an exclusive space

for the presentation of this art form, whether by amateurs or leaders. "This is a place for budding cartoonists as well as professionals to showcase their talents. Humour, as seen in cartoons, is an integral part of our daily existence. Imagine newspapers and magazines without cartoons," he says.

Currently on display are cartoons by *Deccan Herald* cartoonist, Late B.V. Ramamurthy, who was well-known for his *Mr Citizen* series. One of his famous cartoon shows Bush, in cowboy gear, pushing Musharraf and exhorting him, "Go ahead Musharraf, be brave, save democracy". The inaugural show also has cartoons by V.G. Narendra and B.G. Gujarappa, also supporters of this project.

The gallery will be equipped with a library containing special collections of cartoons and a full-fledged cartoon bibliography from the world over. After the three-month exhibition, award winning pieces of cartoonists from around the globe, right from Peter Brookes to Steve Bell to Charles Griffin, will be on display

by Stephen David

The country's lone cartoon gallery has world-famous works



GIREESH G.V.

dance festival

Rhythm Corner

HYDERABAD Kuchipudi dancers Raja and Radha Reddy will be hosting a three-day music and dance festival, beginning August 31, to mark the opening of their school, Natya Tarangini, in Hyderabad. The two dancers opened their first school in Delhi in 1976 to popularise this dance form. On the first day, the duo, along with their disciples, will be performing traditional items from their repertoire. The second day will open with a *jugalbandi*—a meeting of carnatic and the contemporary featuring Ella Venkateshwar Rao and Bikram Ghosh followed by Kathak recital by Shovana Narayan. The last day will feature Odissi recital by Sharon Lowen followed by a performance by Hariharan. At Rabindra Bharathi auditorium.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

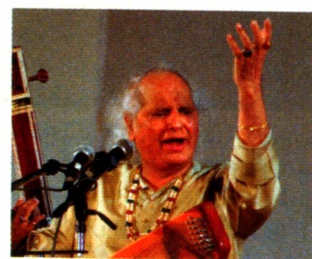


Radha and Raja Reddy

music

Maestros United

DELHI Various artistes will be coming together to celebrate 60 years of Indian Independence through music and poetry. The festival, 'Tiranga', on August 31, organised by the Indian Council for Cultural Relations and conceptualised by Durga Jasraj, will feature poet Javed Akhtar, Pandit Jasraj, Pandit Hari-



ISHAN TANKHA

Pandit Jasraj

prasad Chaurasia, U. Shrinivas (mandolin), Bhawani Shankar (pakhawaj), Vijay Ghatge (tabla) and S.V. Ramani at Sri Fort auditorium.